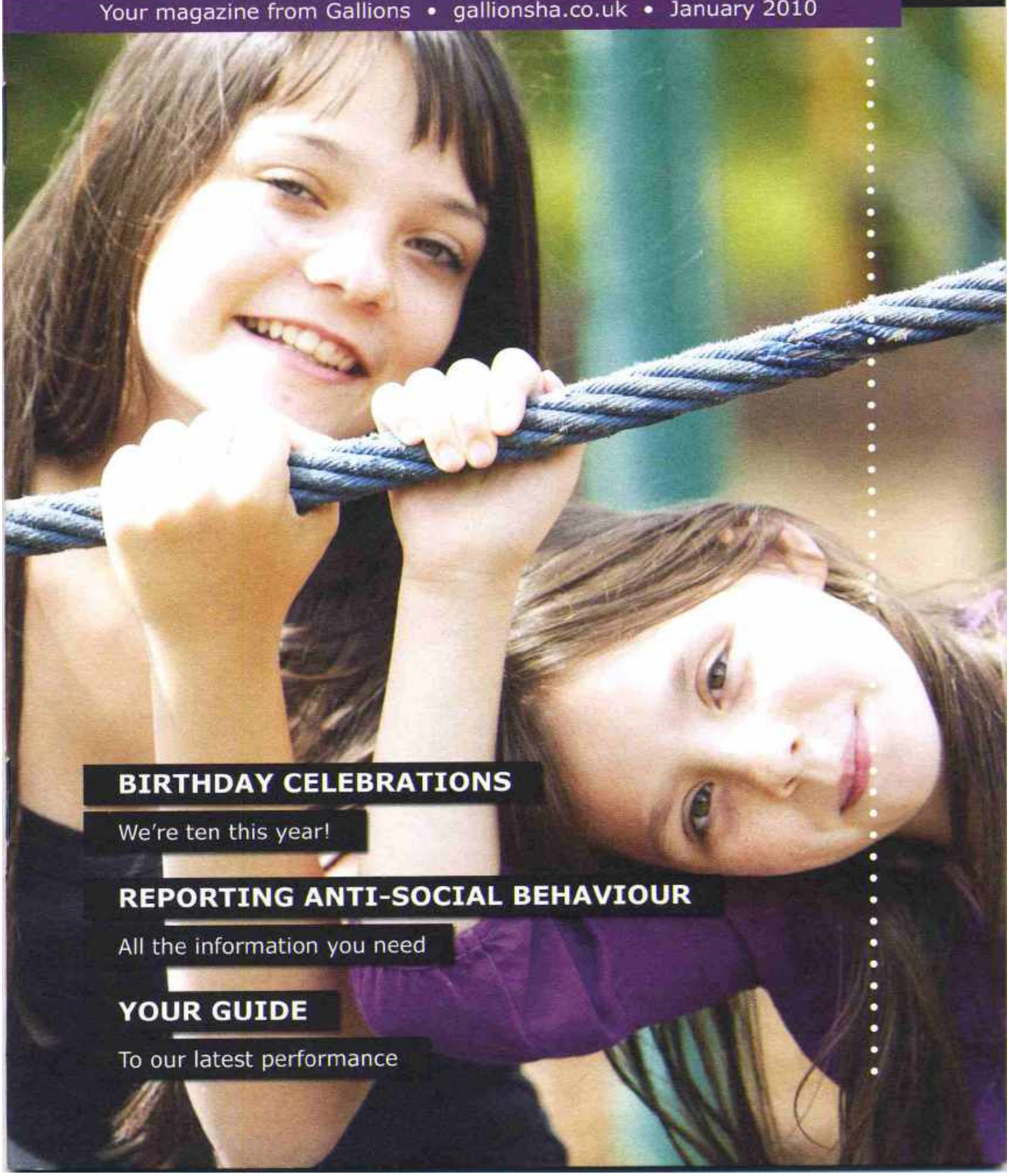
thamesview

Your magazine from Gallions • gallionsha.co.uk • January 2010



BIRTHDAY CELEBRATIONS

We're ten this year!

REPORTING ANTI-SOCIAL BEHAVIOUR

All the information you need

YOUR GUIDE

To our latest performance

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Thamesview gets even better!

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The latest from your neighbourhood

7 RELAX & ENJOY

Events and puzzles

9 GALLIONS AND YOU

Essential news and updates

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Bite-sized local information

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Mixed Sources
Product group from well-managed forests and other controlled sources
www.fsc.org Cert no. SGS-COC-003351
© 1996 Forest Stewardship Council

NEW YEAR, NEW LOOK!



Welcome to your improved Thamesview magazine for 2010! We have made some great changes in this issue to make your magazine easier to understand, more fun to read and we've even made it smaller so you can take it almost anywhere!

We've kept all your favourite articles, games and events information and made the improvements that you told us about. Thank you to Mr Woodage of Hasler Close, Miss Abdullah of Hill House, O.S. Eveso of Binsey Walk, Maurice T of Octavia Way, Mr and Mrs Edwards of Fieldfare Road and Mary Oviade of Masham House, to name just a few of you, whose ideas have been included in the magazine.

We would love to know what you think about the new style Thamesview so fill in our feedback form on page 5 for the chance to win £50 in high street gift vouchers.

GRB
GALLIONS RESIDENTS BOARD
APPROVED

Gallions Housing Association

IT'S OUR BIRTHDAY!



2010 is a big year for Gallions Housing Association – it marks our 10th year as a registered social landlord.

We are looking for local groups, individuals and businesses that were also 'born' during the millennium year to tell us their story. One lucky entrant will win a fantastic prize and we will feature the recollections from the last 10 years in the next issue of Thamesview and on our website.

Check our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk or visit our reception area for more information about our successes since 2000.

PAINT IT GREEN







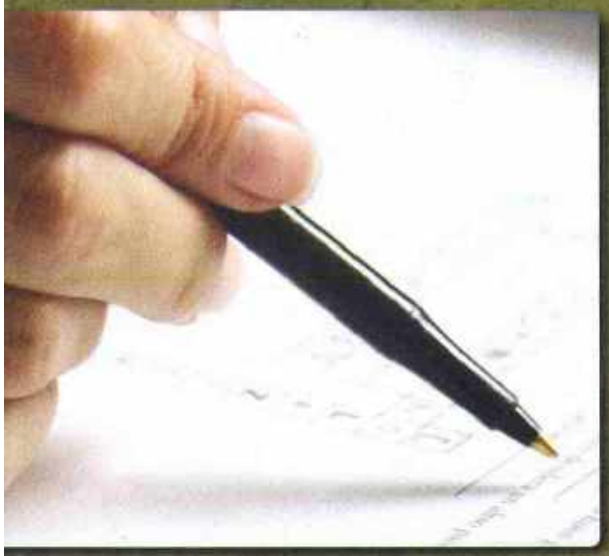
We work with Axis to repair and maintain 5500 Gallions homes. This means we use A LOT of paint! But together we make sure that none of it damages the environment. All our paints are environmentally responsible, right from the choice of paint, which is water-based wherever possible, with greener production processes, a long life-cycle and reduced levels of internal air pollution in homes. We process left-over paint so that it can be recycled safely, recycle all cans and donate useable paint to community projects. You can recycle your household paint too, get in touch with the Community RePaint scheme online at www.communityrepaint.org.uk or call 0113 200 3959.

50 VOLUNTEERS, 3 GREAT PROJECTS

In the autumn of 2009 Moody's Investors Service, a global credit and risk agency, got in touch with us about volunteering in our neighbourhoods. We jumped at the chance as residents had just suggested three fantastic environmental improvement projects to us. We invited the 50-strong team along in December to get to work. The volunteers worked extremely hard gardening at Crossway Park (near the football club), clearing Southmere Lake of dumped rubbish and painting under the garage area at Tavy Bridge to make it brighter.

Please get in touch with the Neighbourhood Projects Team on 0800 83 84 81 if you have an idea for a community or environmental project. We'll do our best to make it happen!





BOOST YOUR LITERACY AND NUMERACY

Learndirect is on your doorstep if you live in Thamesmead. They offer a range of great courses, including GCSE level qualifications in English and Maths. For many people funding is available for the courses. You can start whenever you like and access the online courses at home, work or for free at your local centre. You will be fully supported by qualified staff and they will fit appointments around your lifestyle.

To find out more call 0208 320 6361 or pop into the Southlake Centre in Seacourt Road (off Yarnton Way in Thamesmead).

READER ! IDEA

Thank you to Maurice of Octavia Way for suggesting we include more about adult education opportunites.

£50 FOR YOUR FEEDBACK

Tell us what you think of this issue of Thamesview magazine for the chance to win £50 in high street gift vouchers. Return this form to Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR by 12 February 2010 to be entered into our prize draw.

How would you rate the new look for Thamesview?
Excellent ☐ Good ☐ Poor ☐

How easy was it to understand the magazine?
Very easy ☐ Quite easy ☐
Not very easy ☐

Do you like the smaller size?
Yes ☐ No ☐ Maybe ☐

Do you have any other comments about this issue of Thamesview?

.....

.....

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

FREE MESSAGES FROM THE POLICE

Neighbourhood Link is a new messaging service from the Metropolitan Police. Once you register for this free service you will receive regular email, text or recorded message updates about your chosen local topics, including neighbourhood watch, crime statistics and events. Sign up online at www.neighbourhoodlink.met.police.uk or contact your local Safer Neighbourhoods Team (numbers on page 13) for more information.



READER ! IDEA

Thank you to Mr Woodage of Hasler Close for suggesting that we publish details of different groups each edition.

GREAT SERVICES NEAR YOU

LOTS OF LOCAL CLUBS, GROUPS AND SERVICES ARE LISTED ON OUR WEBSITE AT WWW.GALLIONSHA.CO.UK. WE HAVE FEATURED JUST A COUPLE OF OUR FAVOURITE OPPORTUNITIES HERE:

DISABILITY LAW SERVICE

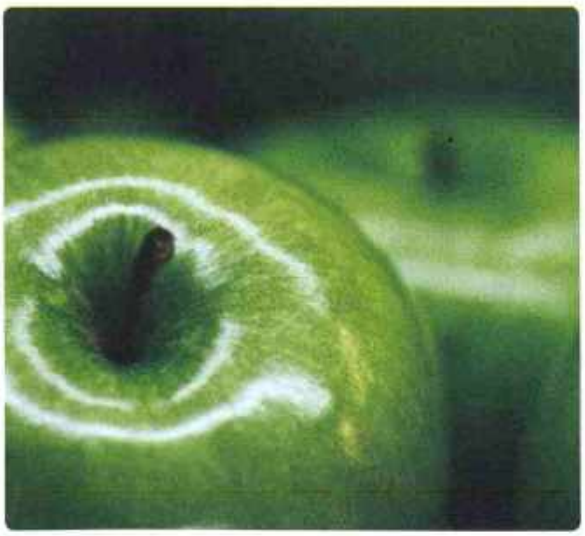
This national charity offers free legal advice for disabled people. They can help with a range of issues including problems with disability benefits, support services or discrimination. Call them on 0207 791 9800 or visit www.dls.org.uk for more information.

THAMES21

If you would like to help your local environment in 2010, try volunteering with Thames21. They work in communities to keep lakes, canals and waterways clean, tidy and wildlife friendly. Regular clean up events take place in Thamesmead so visit www.thames21.org.uk or call 020 7248 7171 to sign up.

TRUST THAMESMEAD AND GREENWICH COMMUNITY FOOD CO-OP

If you are after a healthy start to the New Year, why not volunteer for this fruit and vegetable stall outside Arnott Community Centre in Arnott Close? If you can spare 1-4 hours between 10.00am and 2.00pm every Friday and would like to get trained in customer service and money handling, call Roz at Trust Thamesmead on 020 8320 4482.



DATES FOR YOUR DIARY

GALLIONS FURNITURE BANK - 26 JANUARY
THE OLD BETTING SHOP, TAVY BRIDGE
Gallions tenants can pick up good quality used furniture for free. Call Helen Chambers on 0800 83 84 81 for full details.

PRAISE PARTY EVENTS - 30 JANUARY
JUBILEE COMMUNITY CENTRE, TITMUSS AVENUE
Arts and crafts, games, cooking, songs and more for 5-11 year olds from Thamesmead Christian Fellowship. Call 07815 135923 for more information.

THAMES21 CANAL CLEAN UP - 9 FEBRUARY
WOODPECKER ROAD
Anyone can volunteer for this canal clean up and do something great for their community. Contact Solomon Small from Thames21 on 07826 913261.

SHROVE TUESDAY - 16 FEBRUARY

ST PATRICK'S DAY PARADE - 14 MARCH
TRAFALGAR SQUARE, LONDON.
Celebrate all things Irish with this great free event for all the family. There will be music, culture, crafts, dance and food from midday. Visit www.london.gov.uk/stpatricksday or call 020 7983 4000 for more information.

PASSOVER - 30 MARCH

Editor's note: Thamesview does not endorse or recommend any clubs, groups or events listed. We aim to provide accurate and up to date information but cannot be held responsible for any misleading or inaccurate information supplied to us.

WIN WITH OUR VALENTINES
WORDSEARCH

Love will be in the air on the fourteenth of February so this wordsearch contains six romantic words. Find them all and you could win a £25 Morrisons voucher.

Hearts	Cupid
Red Rose	Chocolate
Amour	Diamonds

A	E	S	S	A	F	T	R	G	T	D	A	H
R	D	A	A	U	F	M	E	A	X	N	F	Z
J	A	D	N	T	H	I	D	S	A	Z	S	A
F	C	I	T	R	T	S	R	V	C	X	N	H
T	A	A	A	G	Y	T	O	E	A	I	O	A
U	V	M	T	H	O	L	S	T	W	R	W	X
A	M	O	U	R	A	E	E	A	A	E	M	T
K	S	N	S	C	V	T	G	L	N	I	A	A
E	G	D	T	N	U	O	D	O	Y	N	N	D
Y	A	S	R	J	B	E	A	C	A	D	I	O
A	R	U	A	Y	A	U	A	O	U	P	A	L
O	A	N	E	E	L	W	T	H	U	E	H	J
E	A	X	H	B	A	X	A	C	U	P	I	L

DID YOU KNOW...

The tradition of St Valentine's Day is thought to stem from two Christian martyrs, Valentine of Rome and Valentine of Terni. Despite the legends surrounding these saints, it was not until the 14th century when Geoffrey Chaucer wrote in The Parliament of Fowles about a great marriage overseen by St Valentine, that the name became associated with romance. Love poetry prevails in today's celebrations, as approximately 1 billion Valentine's cards are sent annually.



Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR or drop it into our reception by 12 February 2010. The winner will be selected at random.

Name: .....

Address: .....

.....

.....

Telephone: .....

Email: .....

Congratulations to Mrs Payne of Cherbury Close who was selected as the winner of our last wordsearch competition.

TACKLING ARREARS



Last month we ran an extremely successful campaign aimed at reducing rent arrears. We wanted to remind residents that paying their rent should be a priority, even during the festive period, and to offer assistance with debt or benefit issues. During just one week in December our staff made 561 home visits and 128 telephone calls to residents in arrears. 258 of our residents made payments or arrangements to clear their arrears during the campaign. We also referred 27 residents to our Welfare Benefits Officer.

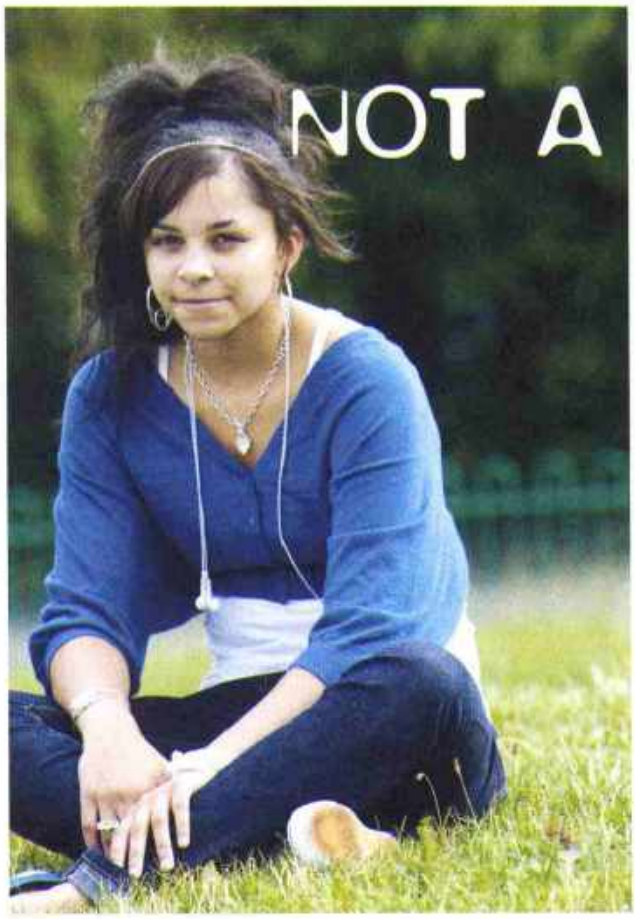
We are planning similar initiatives later this year. If you need help with paying your rent please call us on 0800 83 84 81.

COMPARE THE LANDLORDS

The Tenant Services Authority (TSA) is the regulator of affordable housing providers like us. They have developed a new online service so you can compare the performance and service levels of the landlords in your area. This means you can see how well Gallions is doing. The service is free and all you need to do is enter your post code.

Visit www.tenantservicesauthority.org or call 0845 230 7000 for more details. If you haven't been to this site before spend some time looking around – it's full of great information and opportunities for tenants.





NOT A WASTE

This summer we launched a free rubbish collection service for residents living in our tower blocks. This scheme was such a success that we're extending it so even more residents can benefit. We're also trialling a new recycling facility in the Moorings area (Harold Wilson House) of Thamesmead. These initiatives are designed to help make your neighbourhood a 'greener' place to be. Contact us on 0800 83 84 81 if you have a large item of rubbish to be removed or would like to find out more about how you can look after your local environment.

ADAPTATIONS IN YOUR HOME

If you need minor changes in your home because you are disabled or have a mobility problem please contact us on 0800 83 84 81. We can help with small adaptations like grab rails, lever taps and shower attachments, or refer you to your local authority if major changes need to be made in your home. So far this financial year (from April 2009) we have carried out 80 small adaptations, with 28 completed within just 6 days and 32 within 21 days.



WORKING TOGETHER TO REDUCE SUB-LETTING

In December the government launched the very first national campaign aimed at identifying and reducing sub-letting in social housing. Following this, we have started work on a project with the London Borough of Greenwich to prevent sub-letting and make our homes available to people that really need them. In the coming months we will be visiting our residents to check their tenancy details. If we contact you, please don't worry, it doesn't mean we suspect you of sub-letting.

If you think a home near you is being sub-let please tell us about it. Call us on 0800 83 84 81, speak to your Housing Officer or email fraud@greenwich.gov.uk. All reports will be confidential.

GALLIONS TO ISSUE DOG CONTROL ORDERS



Over the last few months we have been working with the London Borough of Greenwich to update Dog Control Orders. These Orders mean that authorised officers can issue on the spot fines to people who don't control or clean up after their dogs. Our Neighbourhood Wardens, along with certain Greenwich Council Officers and the police, can issue the £75 fines in the Greenwich area.

Contact us on 0800 83 84 81 to report anti-social behaviour involving dog ownership or visit www.greenwich.gov.uk to find out more about Dog Control Orders.

ALWAYS REPORT IT

At our Annual Residents Conference in the autumn some of you told us you were unsure about how to report anti-social behaviour. We have put together this information to make things easier for you.

The Gallions Wardens and our Housing Officers work closely with the Police Safer Neighbourhoods Team and local councils to tackle anti-social behaviour. If you report a neighbourhood issue to us we will contact you within three working days to discuss the problems. We will keep your identity confidential too.

We offer mediation, access to advice services and regular support. We will always try to resolve issues as quickly as possible but we can, and have, evicted tenants for continued anti-social behaviour. There are lots of ways to report anti-social behaviour so you can pick the most convenient way for you:



UK EMERGENCY SERVICES - 999

Call when a crime is happening, someone suspected of a crime is nearby, someone is injured, being threatened or in danger.

METROPOLITAN POLICE NON-EMERGENCIES - 0300 123 1212

Report a crime that has already taken place and where the suspect is no longer nearby.

CRIMESTOPPERS - 0800 555 111

Give information about a crime anonymously 24 hours a day. You will never be asked to give your name or address.

LOCAL NON-EMERGENCY POLICING TEAMS

Thamesmead East Safer Neighbourhoods Team – 020 8721 2049.
Thamesmead Moorings Safer Neighbourhoods Team - 020 8721 2630.
Abbey Wood Safer Neighbourhoods Team - 020 8721 2286.
Lesnes Safer Neighbourhoods Team - 020 8721 2602.
Blackwall Safer Neighbourhoods Team - 020 8721 2877.
Limehouse Safer Neighbourhoods Team - 020 8721 2852.

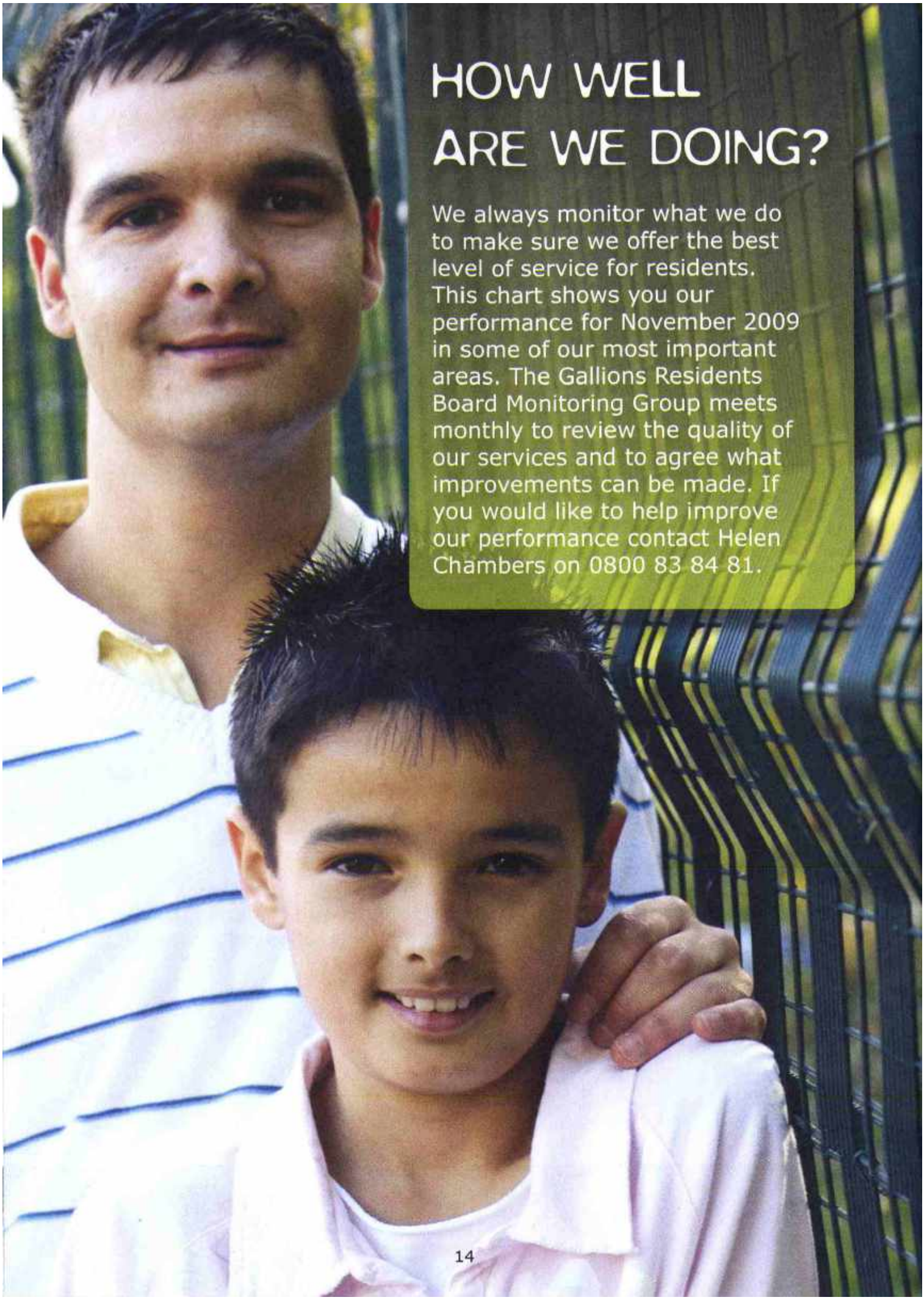
GALLIONS HOUSING ASSOCIATION – 0800 83 84 81

Contact us about any issues in your neighbourhood. You can also fill in the anti-social behaviour form on our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk or call our dedicated hotline on 0208 320 3441.

METROPOLITAN POLICE Working together for a safer London

Bexley Community BCSP Safety Partnership
Keeping Bexley Safe

LONDON BOROUGH OF BEXLEY



HOW WELL ARE WE DOING?

We always monitor what we do to make sure we offer the best level of service for residents. This chart shows you our performance for November 2009 in some of our most important areas. The Gallions Residents Board Monitoring Group meets monthly to review the quality of our services and to agree what improvements can be made. If you would like to help improve our performance contact Helen Chambers on 0800 83 84 81.

MONTHLY STATISTICS: NOVEMBER 2009

Description	2008/9	2009/10	Target	Performance Trend	Current Status
Overall resident satisfaction	77%	77%	75%	↑	☺
Void re-let period (how long it takes to make an empty property available to a new tenant)	35 days	25.6 days	28 days	↓	☺
Emergency repairs completed	97.1%	99.8%	97%	↑	☺
Urgent and routine repairs completed	96.4%	99.4%	95%	↑	☺
Resident satisfaction with repairs	83%	79%	88%	↓	☹
Complaints answered within timescale	100%	98%	85%	↓	☺
Complaints resolved at stages 1 or 2	98.2%	100%	95%	↑	☺
Percentage of residents satisfied with complaints process	70.5%	80%	70%	↑	☺
Rent collected	98.9%	99.2%	100%	↑	☹
Calls answered within 20 seconds	75.8%	83.9%	80%	↑	☺

Performance Status		Overall Performance Trend	
☹	Performance is below target	↑	Performance is better than last year
☺	Performance is above target	↓	Performance is worse than last year

HOMEOWNER NEWS

This issue of Homeowner News focuses on health and safety issues at home. Here are our top tips for looking after yourself and your family:

Fire

- Fit smoke alarms on each level of your home and test the batteries every week.
- Take care when cooking and don't leave the cooker unattended.
- Use a secure holder for candles and always put them out before leaving the room.
- Always stub cigarettes out properly and dispose of them carefully.
- Plan a fire escape route from your home and discuss it with your family.
- Keep fire doors closed and do not use airshafts or intake cupboards as storage areas. You may be charged for any damage to storage areas and your belongings could be removed to safe storage at our offices.
- Call 999 immediately if you are in danger.

All Londoners can request a home fire safety visit from the London Fire Brigade. Visit www.london-fire.gov.uk/HomeFireSafetyVisit or call 020 8555 1200 to book an appointment.

Gas

Every year about 30 people die from carbon monoxide poisoning caused by gas appliances and flues which have not been properly installed or maintained. You can't see it, taste it or smell it but carbon monoxide can kill without warning in a matter of hours.

As a homeowner you have a responsibility to ensure that your gas fittings and appliances are safe and regularly maintained. Formal checks should be carried out annually by a Gas Safe registered installer.

Electricity

- Electrical appliances should be serviced once a year by a qualified electrician.
- Ensure that wires are held securely inside plugs and the casing is not loose.
- Use just one extension lead per socket.
- Make sure you use the right fuse for the appliance. Check the manual or sticker for more information. Up to 700 watts = 3 amp fuse. 700 – 1000 watts = 5 amp fuse. More than 1000 watts = 13 amp fuse.

Visit the Health and Safety Executive website at www.hse.gov.uk or call 0845 345 0055 for more information about staying safe at home.

CAREERS AT GALLIONS

Our current employment opportunities are available on our website.

COMPLAINTS, COMMENTS AND COMPLIMENTS

Please contact us if you have something to share about our service. We don't mind whether it's good or bad because we use all feedback to improve what we do.
Complaints@gallionsha.co.uk • www.gallionsha.co.uk • 0800 83 84 81

PUBLICATION DETAILS

Thamesview is published by Gallions Housing Association, Harrow Manor Way, London, SE2 9XH and is free to Gallions' residents and anyone else who would like a copy.

We offer a comprehensive translation service to make communicating with us easy. If you would like Thamesview translated into your own language or need an audio, large print or Braille version please contact us.

Chúng tôi cung cấp dịch vụ biên dịch cho tất cả các loại ngôn ngữ để giúp quí vị dễ dàng liên lạc với chúng tôi. Nếu quí vị muốn Bản Đánh giá Hàng năm về Cư dân năm 2008/09 này (Thamesview) được dịch sang ngôn ngữ của quí vị hoặc quí vị cần một phiên bản khác bằng âm thanh, in khổ lớn hoặc Chữ nổi, xin hãy liên hệ với chúng tôi.

ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਵਿਚਾਰ ਵਟਾਂਦਰੇ ਨੂੰ ਸੌਖਾ ਬਣਾਉਨ ਲਈ ਅਸੀਂ ਇੱਕ ਵਿਆਪਕ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਸੇਵਾ ਪੇਸ਼ ਕਰਦੇ ਹਾਂ,ਜੇ ਤੁਸੀਂ ਇਸ ਰੈਜੀਡੈਂਟਸ ਐਨੁਅਲ ਰੀਵਿਓ 2008/09 ਦਾ ਤਰਜਮਾ ਆਪਣੀ ਭਾਸ਼ਾ ਵਿਚ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ ਜਾਂ ਇਸ ਨੂੰ ਆਡੀਓ,ਮੋਟੀ ਛਪਾਈ ਜਾਂ ਬਰੇਲ ਦੇ ਰੂਪ ਵਿਚ ਚਾਹੁੰਦੇ ਹੋ ਤਾਂ ਕਿਰਪਾ ਕਰਕੇ ਸਾਡੇ ਨਾਲ ਸੰਪਰਕ ਕਰੋ।

為便於與我們溝通，我們提供廣泛的翻譯服務。倘若您希望將本 2008/09 居民年度綜評翻譯成您的母語，或需要以音頻、大字體或盲文格式提供，請聯絡我們。

NOTICEBOARD

OUR NEW EMAIL ADDRESS

Make a note of our new email address – enquiries@gallionsha.co.uk. You can use this email address for all general enquiries, including questions, comments or suggestions. Remember that you can call us on 0800 83 84 81 or visit our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk too.

A NEW HOME

This spring we are aiming to move some of our staff to a new head office in Sidcup. But don't worry, our office in Harrow Manor Way will stay open and you will still be able to access our services. The reception opening hours will not change so you will be able to visit us between 8am and 6pm, Monday to Friday to discuss any queries you have. Our phone number – 0800 83 84 81 will stay the same too. We are working to minimise any possible disruption to our services and we'll keep you updated about the move.

RESIDENT FINED FOR FLY-TIPPING

It's illegal to dump rubbish in the street and the Gallions Neighbourhood Wardens now have the power to issue fixed penalty notices for this crime. A Greenwich resident was recently fined £1000 for not putting rubbish in the correct place. So always dispose of your waste in the bins provided. If it's not where it should be, it's fly-tipping and you too could have to pay a big fine.

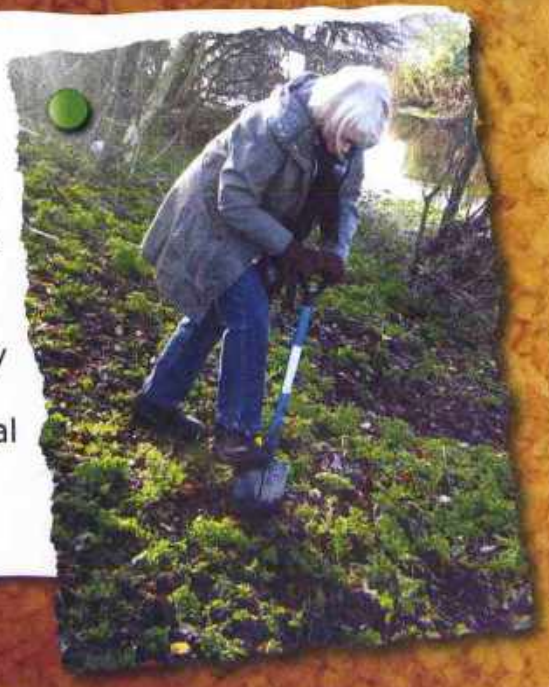


SEND YOUR REPAIR PHOTOS

We have recently improved our online repair reporting system so you can upload photos of a repair, damp problem or issues in communal areas. This will help us diagnose your problem as quickly as possible. Visit our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk to try it for yourself.

TREES FOR THAMESMEAD

Working with Gallions Housing Association, the Friends of Thamesmead Parks Group applied for 25 free trees from the Kent County Council Free Trees Scheme. The application was successful and on Saturday 12th December the group planted 25 native trees in Southmere Park. They even found time to put up some bird nesting boxes! If you would like to help improve the local environment, contact us on 0800 83 84 81 and we will put you in touch with the right people.



CONFERENCE FEEDBACK

Thank you to everyone that joined us for our third Annual Residents Conference last autumn. The feedback about our presentations and workshops was fantastic and we have now put it all together in a short booklet. You can pick up the booklet from our reception in Harrow Manor Way or download it from our website at www.gallionsha.co.uk. We will be improving what we do because of your comments, including giving more notice for the conference, extending workshops and focusing on our future plans. Contact the neighbourhood projects team on 0800 83 84 81 if you have any ideas or suggestions for the event in 2010.



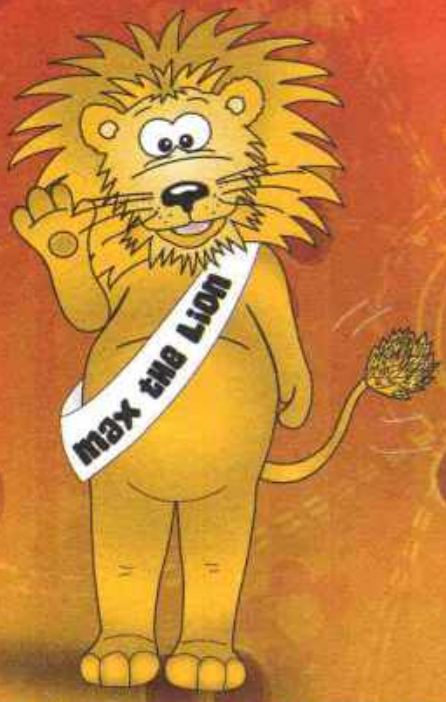
FREE OLYMPIC TOURS

If you live in the Greenwich area you can take part in a free bus tour of the new Olympic site. During the hour-long trip you will be able to see the major venues including the Olympic Stadium and Aquatics Centre. Tours run Tuesday to Sunday at different times. To book your place call 0300 2012 001.

KidsView

SPRINGTIME WORDSEARCH

This wordsearch is full of words about springtime. Find them all and you could win a fantastic family day out at the London Aquarium.



Q	V	Y	S	T	E	T	R	Y	T	F	A	Y
R	X	D	D	U	T	A	E	A	X	N	F	Z
Z	A	A	N	V	S	R	S	G	H	B	I	L
F	C	F	T	R	G	S	R	T	T	X	N	P
T	A	F	Y	A	Y	T	F	E	E	I	G	A
U	V	O	M	H	N	B	S	F	W	R	X	Q
U	M	D	U	R	A	E	E	A	A	S	M	T
K	S	I	F	M	O	S	S	O	L	B	A	K
E	G	L	T	G	U	R	D	T	Y	M	U	O
Y	H	S	U	N	N	Y	A	C	A	A	I	O
A	M	U	J	Y	E	U	X	O	T	L	A	L
O	A	N	E	E	L	F	T	H	D	E	H	J
E	A	P	I	C	N	I	C	T	R	P	I	G

Daffodils
Blossom
Sunny
Easter
Lambs
Picnic

This competition is just for kids under 12. Please return your completed wordsearch and details to: Anita Dagger, Gallions Housing Association, Freepost SE6691, London, SE2 9BR or drop it into our reception by 12 February 2010. The winner will be selected at random.

Child's name:

Parent's name:

Address:

Telephone:

Well done to Ade Batula of Argali House who won our last competition.